

Introduction to Biblical Greek

Glossary of Terms

Week 1

1. **Transliteration:** To write the English alphabet equivalent to the Greek word (θεός = *theos*).
2. **Diphthongs:** A diphthong is two vowels that produce one sound. The second vowel is always an *i* or an *u*.
3. **Breathing marks:** Greek has two breathing marks. Every word beginning with a vowel has a breathing mark.
 - a. The rough breathing is a *ˆ* placed over the vowel, and adds an “h” sound to the word. The word *υῖός* is pronounced “*huios*.”
 - b. The smooth breathing is a *ˊ* and is not pronounced. The word *αἰώνιος* is pronounced “*aiōnios*.”
 - c. Every word beginning with a vowel must have either a rough or smooth breathing mark. If the word begins with a diphthong, or more than one vowel, the breathing mark is over the second vowel. For example, the breathing mark on *υῖός* is above the *iota*, and the breathing mark *ἀγάπη* is above the *alpha*.
4. **Gamma nasal:** When a gamma is immediately followed by *γ*, *κ*, *χ*, or *ξ*, it is pronounced as a “n.” For example, the word *ἄγγελος* is pronounced and transliterated “*angelos*” and not “*aggelos*.” The *gamma* pronounced like a “n” is called a *gamma nasal*.

5. **Accents** (not assessed): There are three accents. Almost every Greek word has an accent mark, they are placed over vowels and show which syllable receives the stress when pronounced.
- a. Acute Accent (´)
 - b. Grave Accent (`)
 - c. Circumflex (^ or ~)
6. ***iota* subscript**: An *iota* subscript is a small ι written under the vowels α , η , or ω (α , η , ω) and normally is the last letter in a word. This ι has no effect on the pronunciation or transliteration.